# Lena Varga-Holm

Senior Data Engineer

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with experience owning and operating a production data platform, ingestion systems, orchestration, and cloud data warehouses at scale. Built production streaming and CDC pipelines, modernised warehouse transformations, and improved platform performance and cost. Experienced with Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka and Snowflake, with hands-on AWS cloud data engineering and cloud data warehouse experience, including warehouse performance optimisation.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Programming and query languages:** Python, SQL
**Data platforms and warehousing:** Snowflake, Redshift, AWS Glue Data Catalog, PostgreSQL
**Data engineering:** Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, PySpark, Great Expectations, Snowpipe Streaming
**Data modelling and optimisation:** dbt models, incremental models, warehouse performance optimisation, and data quality testing
**Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS MSK, AWS EMR, S3, Terraform
**CI/CD and testing:** GitHub Actions, pytest

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Senior Data Engineer** *2022–Present*
Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o.

- Own the design, build and day-to-day operation of the production data platform's ingestion and orchestration, using Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka.
- Designed and built a shipment-event streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling to support reprocessing failed events without data loss.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to documented, tested dbt models; introduced incremental models and slim CI in GitHub Actions, reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Optimised Snowflake warehouse sizing and auto-suspend settings and removed unused tables, reducing monthly costs from approximately 38k to 24k in 2024.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Mentor two mid-level engineers and run data platform office hours.

**Data Engineer** *2019–2022*
Kovalent Pay

- Designed Redshift cloud data warehouse solutions and developed PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR.
- Worked on data quality using Great Expectations.
- Built a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers; reduced finance team's manual reconciliation from around three days to four hours per month-end.

## SELECTED PROJECTS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

**Open-source contribution** *2023*

Airflow provider package

- Contributed to an open-source Airflow provider through two merged pull requests, including a pagination fix and tests.

## EDUCATION

**MSc, Computer Science**
Northgate Technical University

- Thesis: Incremental materialized views

## CERTIFICATION

**AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate**
May 2024

## COMMUNITY

- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.